probable that I shall go on to Teheran where I have a friend Manoocher Khan[12] the second minister of state who would immediately give me any quantity of silk and take my goods. Pray send me the best information you can as to the prices of silk, wool, opium, yellow berries, and gums generally if you could send me out the list prices current it would be of great use. I have taken silk samples from hence and hope to do good in this article.

Syeed Khan is still here. We are the best friends possible, he has many plans and great talent for carrying them into execution and as Charles Hanson says, I have but little doubt that in the end some of them will hit, it is decidedly our policy to be well with him. He has at last succeeded in procuring from the Porte his recognition as Persian political and mercantile agent at Constantinople and he leaves this in two days by way of Genoa for England, and I do not think it impossible but that he may succeed there, you will of course be very civil, do him any services in your powers and above all send me as full information as possible as to what he does. We have entered into a sort of agreement with regard to the silk I may bring, he gives me letters to his friends in Persia who are the possessors of quantities and in any amount of silk I may procure through his mediation, above the value of my own goods in Persia, we are to be equal sharers, that is to say he has a half share in the profit or loss of that which is procured on credit, having nothing to do with my goods or that part of the silk or other property I may procure in exchange but merely in the overplus which he gives his name to as joint security — but this I am at liberty either to use or not as I see fit — on arrival, I cannot see any possible danger in this but probable advantage therefore do not consider you will blame me in having thus far connected myself with him, besides I wish to stand well with him for the chances of the future, and you will of course act upon this principle. I know no man more likely to work himself up again. I now come to the question of our shipment from this to Trebizonde.

I enclose you the bills of lading and C. Hanson has written to his house in London full particulars of the ship, who can be referred to if you wish to insure, a part to cover English engagements, the company here would have done it, but as their capital is limited and they have already taken a considerable amount on board this vessel they could not do more, but as my goods are all in cases, *coppered,* and not subject to an average, they ought to do it in London at from two to two and a half per cent. C. Hanson is shipping goods by her of which he only insures a small part of, there is seldom any instance of a vessel being lost going to Trebizonde the passage is a very short one, the ship good, and the Captain has traded here for twenty years, and we are with the property in case of getting

[12] Manuchehr Khan, governor of Ghilan, later governor of Ispahan, and commander of the expedition against the Bactrian chief, Mohammed Taki Khan.

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